

Bras

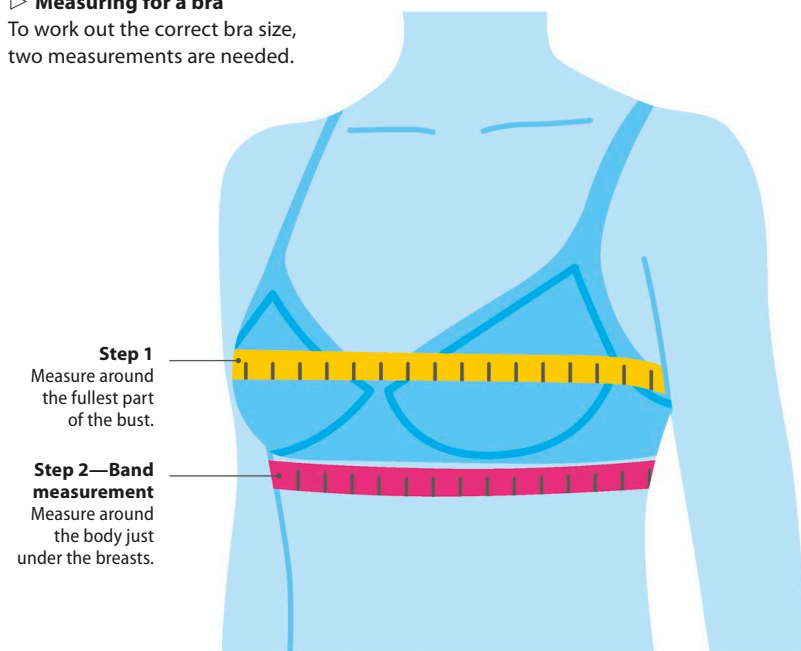
Wearing a bra provides support for the breast tissue and makes some girls and women feel more comfortable. There are many different styles, colors, and designs available.

Getting measured

Choosing the correct bra size is very important, as a poorly fitting bra can affect posture and potentially cause back pain. It is possible to work out the right bra size at home, but in order to ensure a bra fits properly, it's best to get fitted in a store by a bra-fitting expert. It's okay to feel embarrassed, but it helps to remember that professional bra fitters are experienced and regularly measure people for their first bra. They should be kind and understanding.

▷ Measuring for a bra

To work out the correct bra size, two measurements are needed.



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◀ **40–41** Breasts

Body image

72–73 ▶

Step 1

Measure around the fullest part of the bust, in line with the nipples. The measuring tape should be straight across the back. Record this number in inches.



Step 2—Band measurement

Measure around the body underneath the breasts, next to the rib cage, again making sure the measuring tape is straight across the back. Record this number in inches. This is the band measurement.



Step 3

Subtract the second measurement from the first. The difference between the two measurements indicates the cup size.

A = Up to 1 in (2.5 cm)

B = Up to 2 in (5 cm)

C = Up to 3 in (8 cm)

D = Up to 4 in (10 cm)

DD = Up to 5 in (13 cm)

E = Up to 6 in (15 cm)

PARENT TIPS

Shopping with your teen

Be sensitive when you broach the subject, as getting a bra can cause mixed emotions for a teen. Ask her how much help she needs when getting measured rather than assuming and doing either too much or too little.

When to get fitted

The average age to start wearing a bra is 11 years old, but everyone develops at different rates. A girl might feel she needs more support when breast buds appear or when some sports start to feel uncomfortable. At that point, it is worth starting to think about getting measured. There are training bras and crop tops available for those who might not have developed yet but want to wear a bra.